

Monthly Budget Worksheet

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A simple plan for the month ahead. Gary has kept the same habits for years: pay every bill on time, set money aside before it can be spent, and never carry a balance. The numbers below reflect a quiet, paid off household where the surplus is the point, not the exception.

Income

Social Security	\$1,850.00
District pension	\$800.00
Church wages	\$600.00
Total income	\$3,250.00

Planned Expenses

Category	Detail	Amount
Property tax	Monthly escrow	\$310.00
Utilities	Electric, gas, water	\$185.00
Groceries	Household food	\$300.00
Insurance	Home and auto	\$220.00
Medicare and medications	Premiums and pharmacy	\$190.00
Household and other	Supplies and upkeep	\$115.00
Total expenses		\$1,320.00

Spending Notes

Groceries are simple: eggs, soup, sandwiches, a baked chicken that stretches across several days, and the breakfast special at the Koffee Kup with Dale. Utilities run a little higher in the deep cold of a South Dakota winter. The medication line covers the COPD inhalers, the blood pressure tablet, and the vitamins.

A surplus of about nineteen hundred dollars is set aside every month. Gary lives fully within his means, owes nothing to anyone, and prefers it that way.